Vertebrate classification

Vertebrates can be classified into five different groups. Vertebrates are classified according to how they feed their young, the way they breathe and the type of body covering they have. Mammals and birds are **warm-blooded,** whereas reptiles, fish and amphibians are **cold-blooded**.

☞ **1** Use the word bank to complete the information about these groups in the table below.

Word bank

skin skin and lungs gills lungs feathers lungs lungs fur scales scales

Group	Body covering	Breathes through
amphibians		
birds		
fish		
mammals		
reptiles		

2 Circle 'true' or 'false' for the following statements.

Reptiles have scales. True/False

Mammals have feathers. True/False

Baby birds drink milk. True/False

Amphibians are cold-blooded. True/False

Fish breathe using gills. True/False

Birds are warm-blooded. True/False

What am I?

3 I have wings and I fly at night. I have a furry body and my young drink milk. I am a b_____, which is a type of m_____.

4 I live in the sea and on land in cold climates. I lay eggs. I don't have wings, but I do have flippers. My body is covered with tiny feathers. I am a p_____, which is a type of b_____.

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